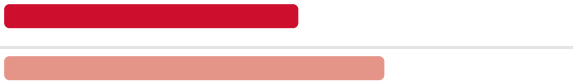
Competitor watch · Q2 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**H1 2026 results (6 months)**	**1,560 EUR**	**+0.2%**	**+5.0%**	**14.4%**	**+90 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	H1 2026 results (6 months)	1,159 GBP	+6.0%	+5.0%	18.7%	+50 bps	Adj. operating margin
Belimo	H1 2026 results (6 months)	676.4 CHF	+20.5%	+29.6%	22.5%	−30 bps	EBIT margin
Xylem	Q2 2026 results	2,336 USD	+1.5%	+1.0%	23.3%	+150 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q2 2026 results	4,415 USD	+9.7%	+5.0%	18.8%	+40 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	Q2 2026 results	763.2 USD	+18.6%	+12.2%	21.0%	−60 bps	Adj. operating margin
Emerson*	Q2 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Mar 2026)	4,562 USD	+2.9%	+0.5%	27.6%	−40 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q2 2026 results	932.6 USD	−17.0%	−17.3%	25.4%	−100 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	H1 2026 results (6 months)	1,696 CHF	−24.8%	+5.7%	13.4%		Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions

Reported margin comparison



Aalberts	**14.4%** +90 bps EBITA margin
IMI	**18.7%** +50 bps Adj. operating margin
Belimo	**22.5%** −30 bps EBIT margin
Xylem	**23.3%** +150 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	**18.8%** +40 bps Organic operating margin
Watts	**21.0%** −60 bps Adj. operating margin
Emerson*	**27.6%** −40 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	**25.4%** −100 bps Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	**13.4%** Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · H1 2026 results (6 months)

Revenue **1,560** EUR m (+0.2% reported) · Organic growth **+5.0%** · EBITA margin **14.4%** +90 bps · EPS before amortisation **EUR 1.47** (EUR 1.38 in H1 2025) · Free cash flow **89** (56 in H1 2025; capex 71 (100))

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	743.0	−7.2%	+2.9%	13.5% (12.9%)	
Industry	489.1	−10.4%	+6.4%	18.6% (16.8%)	
Semicon	335.7	+52.7%	+9.2%	14.2% (11.5%)	

Segment growth: All segments grew organically and improved margins. Semicon +9.2% organic (revenue +53% with acquisitions, EBITA +88%, margin 14.2%); industry +6.4% with margin +180 bps to 18.6%; building +2.9%, margin 13.5%. Divestments cut building and industry revenue by 7–10%.

Outlook: Confident of a full year with improved organic growth and EBITA margin versus 2025.

Source: H1 2026 press release (PDF)

IMI · H1 2026 results (6 months)

Revenue **1,159** GBP m (+6.0% reported) · Organic growth **+5.0%** · Adj. operating margin **18.7%** +50 bps · Adj. basic EPS **63.4p** (+13% vs 56.1p) · Free cash flow **171** (30 in H1 2025; adj. operating cash flow 208 (+32%)) · Process Automation orders **596** (+12% organic; order book 993 (+10%))

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	732.0	+5.9%	+5.0%	19.4% (18.4%)	
Process Automation	473.0	+6.1%	+5.0%		Aftermarket orders 355 (+7%), new construction 241 (+20% organic) incl. £48m nuclear order
Industrial Automation	259.0	+5.7%	+5.0%		
Life Technology	427.0	+6.7%	+5.0%	17.6% (17.8%)	
Climate Control	218.0	+6.9%	+4.0%		Data-centre orders £18m (£6m)
Life Science & Fluid Control	115.0	+2.7%	+5.0%		
Transport	94.0	+11.9%	+8.0%		£3m moved in from Life Science & Fluid Control; organic like-for-like

Segment growth: Automation margin +100 bps to 19.4% on operating leverage and Process Automation aftermarket mix; Process Automation orders +12% (nuclear, power, LNG). Life Technology +5% organic led by Transport (+8%) and Life Science & Fluid Control (+5%); margin −20 bps on cyber-security and data-centre investment. Statutory operating margin 17.3% (14.5%).

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. basic EPS 136p–142p reaffirmed; adj. operating margin flat to slightly up; net debt / EBITDA 1.2x.

Source: H1 2026 results (PDF)

Belimo · H1 2026 results (6 months)

Revenue **676.4** CHF m (+20.5% reported) · Growth in local currencies **+29.6%** · EBIT margin **22.5%** −30 bps · Net income **124.9** (+23.3%; EPS CHF 10.15) · Free cash flow (excl. term deposits) **38.7** (52.8 in H1 2025; capex 45.4 (40.9); net debt 27.7)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Control valves	389.3	+37.0%	+48.3%		Energy Valve, characterized control valves, shift to pressure-independent valves
Damper actuators	253.8	+0.8%	+7.6%		Fire & smoke applications
Sensors and meters	33.3	+30.1%	+39.2%		Customers consolidating field-device suppliers with Belimo
REGIONS					
Americas	341.3	+21.9%	+35.1%		AI data centres (air and direct-to-chip liquid cooling); also life sciences, healthcare, semiconductors
EMEA	240.3	+11.1%	+14.1%		Renovation via RetroFIT+; health, education and industrial buildings; fire & smoke
Asia Pacific	94.8	+45.2%	+58.0%		Strongest growth of all regions

Segment growth: Data-centre cooling delivered slightly more than half of the absolute sales growth; all regions accelerated. Control valves +48.3% in local currencies (now 58% of sales); sensors and meters +39.2%; damper actuators +7.6%. Americas +35.1% and Asia Pacific +58.0% on data centres; EMEA +14.1% on renovation. EBIT margin 22.5% (22.8%): currency headwind partly offset by operating leverage, pricing and mix.

Outlook: EBIT margin above 20% in 2026; H2 growth faces a higher base and annualised price increases.

Source: Semiannual report 2026 (PDF) · H1 2026 report (online)

Xylem · Q2 2026 results

Revenue **2,336** USD m (+1.5% reported) · Organic growth **+1.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **23.3%** +150 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.46** (+16% vs $1.26) · Free cash flow, year to date **219** (169 a year earlier) · Orders **3,086** (+41% organic; +42% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	683.0	+5.1%	+3.0%	26.6% (21.8%)	Orders 669 (-4% organic); Strength in Transport
Applied Water	501.0	+3.7%	+3.0%	21.2% (21.7%)	Orders 538 (+9% organic); Data-centre orders; building solutions
Measurement & Control Solutions	508.0	−5.9%	−1.0%	21.1% (23.1%)	Orders 430 (+2% organic); Energy metering strength
Water Solutions & Services	644.0	+2.5%	+1.0%	25.3% (24.4%)	Orders 1,449 (+147% organic); Outsourced-water order surge (orders +147%)

Segment growth: Orders +41% organic on a WSS outsourced-water surge (+147%) and AW data-centre wins. WI margin +480 bps to 26.6%, WSS +90 bps; MCS margin −200 bps. China declines offset by developed markets.

Outlook: FY 2026: revenue ~USD 9.2bn, organic +2–3%, adj. EBITDA margin 23.1–23.5%, adj. EPS $5.55–5.70.

Source: Q2 2026 earnings package (PDF) · Q2 2026 earnings release

Ecolab · Q2 2026 results

Revenue **4,415** USD m (+9.7% reported) · Organic growth **+5.0%** · Organic operating margin **18.8%** +40 bps · Adj. EPS **$2.09** (+11%; GAAP $1.90)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	2,216	+10.0%	+4.0%	15.7% (16.4%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+7.0%		
Heavy Water	–	–	−1.0%		
High-Tech	–	–	+29.0%		+139% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Light Water	–	–	+3.0%		
Paper	–	–	0.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,617	+3.5%	+4.0%	24.1% (23.6%)	
Institutional	–	–	+3.0%		
Specialty	–	–	+6.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	350.5	+9.1%	+7.0%	20.1% (19.5%)	
Global Life Sciences	221.0	+15.5%	+15.0%	26.5% (21.0%)	

Segment growth: Organic growth accelerated to 5%: High-Tech +29% organic, Life Sciences +15%, Pest +7%, Water +4%. Life Sciences OI +46% with margin 26.5%. CoolIT closed 2 July.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS raised to $8.05–8.25 (+7% to 10%) incl. CoolIT costs; Q3 $2.13–2.23; organic OI margin 20% target.

Source: Q2 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Watts · Q2 2026 results

Revenue **763.2** USD m (+18.6% reported) · Organic growth **+12.2%** · Adj. operating margin **21.0%** −60 bps · Adj. EPS **$3.66** (+18%; GAAP $3.53) · Free cash flow, H1 **98** (105 in H1 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Americas	585.0	+17.4%	+11.6%	25.7% (27.2%)	Price and data-centre volume; acquisitions +USD 28.4m; segment earnings +10.5% organic
Europe	124.6	+12.3%	+9.2%	13.3% (11.7%)	segment earnings +23.8% organic
APMEA	53.6	+56.7%	+30.7%	19.8% (19.0%)	Data centres in China; acquisitions +USD 5.9m; segment earnings +66.2% organic

Segment growth: Organic +12.2%: APMEA +30.7% (data centres in China), Americas +11.6%, Europe +9.2%. Acquisitions added 5.3 pts. Americas margin fell to 25.7% (27.2%) on acquisition dilution, inflation and tariffs; Europe margin 13.3% (11.7%).

Outlook: 2026 raised: organic +8–11%, reported +14–17%, adj. operating margin +20 to +80 bps.

Source: Q2 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF) · Q2 2026 earnings release

Emerson* · Q2 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Mar 2026)

Revenue **4,562** USD m (+2.9% reported) · Underlying growth **+0.5%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **27.6%** −40 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.54** (+4% vs $1.48; GAAP $1.10) · Underlying orders **+5%** (fifth quarter in a row of mid-single digits or better)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Software & Systems	1,503	+3.6%	+1.0%	29.2% (31.7%)	
Control Systems & Software	1,089	−0.4%	−2.0%		Software-renewal timing; strong power and life sciences
Test & Measurement	414.0	+15.6%	+12.0%		Aerospace & defence, semiconductor
Intelligent Devices	2,512	+2.2%	−1.0%	27.9% (27.1%)	
Sensors	1,024	+2.4%	0.0%		Middle East conflict offset by Americas
Final Control	1,488	+2.0%	−1.0%		Power and LNG in the Americas
Safety & Productivity	547.0	+4.8%	+2.0%	21.7% (21.8%)	
REGIONS					
Americas	2,371	+6.1%	+5.0%		US +9%
Asia, Middle East & Africa	1,293	−2.9%	−5.0%		China −9%
Europe	898.0	+3.7%	−4.0%		

Segment growth: Underlying +0.5%: price +3.5% but volume −3% from software-renewal timing (−2 pts) and the Middle East conflict (−1 pt). Software & Systems margin 29.2% (−250 bps, ~3 pts renewal timing); Intelligent Devices margin +80 bps to 27.9%. US +9%, international −5%.

Outlook: FY 2026: underlying +3%, reported +4.5%, adj. EPS $6.45–6.55, FCF USD 3.5–3.6bn.

Source: Q2 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q2 2026 results

Revenue **932.6** USD m (−17.0% reported) · Core sales growth **−17.3%** · Adj. return on sales **25.4%** −100 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.14** (−18%; GAAP $0.80)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	263.7	+5.1%	−0.8%	26.5% (21.8%)	
Water Solutions	422.0	−5.1%	−2.6%	30.0% (24.4%)	
Pool	246.6	−42.3%	−42.4%	23.4% (35.7%)	Larger-than-expected channel inventory destock

Segment growth: Pool core −42.4% on the channel destock, segment income −62%. Flow (ROS 26.5%, +470 bps) and Water Solutions (ROS 30.0%, +560 bps) grew segment income despite slightly lower core sales.

Outlook: 2026 cut in July: adj. EPS $4.60–4.80 (from $5.30–5.40); sales −4% to −7%; adj. operating income −5% to −9%.

Source: Q2 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Georg Fischer · H1 2026 results (6 months)

Revenue **1,696** CHF m (−24.8% reported) · Organic growth, Flow Solutions **+5.7%** · Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions **13.4%** · Net result to shareholders **−77** (deconsolidation loss on Casting exit; +160 in H1 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
GF Flow Solutions	1,584	+5.1%	+5.7%	13.4%	
Industry & Infrastructure	1,001	+8.7%	–	14.4% (14.9%)	
Building	616.0	−2.2%	+3.3%	12.6% (12.5%)	

Segment growth: Industry & Infrastructure revenue +9% with comparable EBITDA up to CHF 144m, though margin eased to 14.4%. Building +3.3% organic (−2% in CHF), margin 12.6% (12.5%). Group revenue −25% after the casting exit.

Outlook: 2026 raised to mid-single-digit organic growth (low single digit); comparable EBITDA margin 14–16% kept.

Source: H1 2026 results presentation (PDF)

Other key competitors (relevance to HFC 1–5)

Caleffi · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Caleffi family) · revenue ~EUR 273m (2025, Caleffi S.p.A. accounts) · FTEs ~1,600; 13 plants in Italy (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Logistics automation (SSI Schäfer) at Fontaneto d'Agogna and Gattico-Veruno: >7,000 catalogue codes and >40 million products made per year (case study, Apr 2026). [Il Giornale della Logistica]

Danfoss · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Danfoss family / Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation) · revenue EUR 9.43bn (2025) · FTEs ~39,300 (H1 2026 report)

- **Performance:** H1 2026: sales EUR 5,254m, organic +15%; operational EBITA EUR 802m (+44%), margin 15.3%. Climate Solutions (incl. heating/hydronic) EUR 1,803m (1,587m), organic +18%, margin 18.1% (15.8%) on data centres and heat pumps in buildings and industry. [Danfoss H1 2026 report · Megaproject]
- **Performance:** Outlook raised: 2026 sales in the upper half of EUR 9.1–10.6bn; operational EBITA margin 14.6–15.6% (from 12.8–14.3%). [Power Progress]
- **M&A:** Entered exclusive talks (June 2026) to acquire Alfagomma, the Italian hydraulic hose and fittings maker. Not heating-related. [Danfoss exclusivity release]

Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Winkelmann Group, family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs >2,100 (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Opened a new production site for heating and cooling storage tanks in Rimavská Sobota, Slovakia (17 Jun 2026), Winkelmann's largest single investment; workforce to grow by ~450 from 2026. [Slovak Spectator · Reflex news]

Bell & Gossett (Xylem) · relevance 4/5 (high)

Xylem (NYSE: XYL), Applied Water segment · revenue Applied Water segment USD 1,849m (2025) · FTEs n/d (part of Xylem)

- **Performance:** Applied Water Q2 2026: revenue USD 501m (+3% organic), adj. EBITDA margin 21.2%; orders +9% on data-centre wins. [Xylem Q2 2026 earnings package (PDF)]

Grundfos · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (Poul Due Jensen Foundation) · revenue DKK 34.7bn / ~EUR 4.7bn (2025) · FTEs 21,433 (end-2025)

- **Performance:** H1 2026: sales +7.7% in local currency to DKK 17.9bn; US >+20%; return to strong growth in Southern and Central Europe; FY growth outlook raised to 7–8%. [Grundfos H1 2026 · Teleborsa]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Broke ground (24 Jun 2026) on a ~143,000 sq ft manufacturing expansion at its US headquarters campus in Brookshire, Texas, completion Q3 2027; efficiency programmes at plants in Mexico and Hungary. [Teleborsa · Grundfos release]

Oventrop · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (family-owned) · revenue ~EUR 273m (Wikipedia; year n/d) · FTEs ~1,000 in Olsberg/Brilon; group ~1,355

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** IG Metall called a two-hour warning strike at Brilon (20 May 2026) to push for a social collective agreement over the move of assembly to Poland; Olsberg is being closed this year. [Radio Sauerland]

Spirotech · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Signed the construction contract for a new headquarters in Helmond (8 May 2026); construction Aug 2026 – Oct 2027, described as the basis for further growth. [Spirotech news · Installatie.nl]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** With SCHÄFER IT-Systems, launched ProtectaCool Rack (Apr 2026): water treatment, pressure maintenance, degassing and dirt/magnetite separation integrated in a server rack for direct liquid cooling in data centres; first shown at Data Centre World Frankfurt (6–7 May). [SCHÄFER IT-Systems release]

ESBE · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Invested in a transfer machine for lead-free brass, bringing more production back to Sweden (Jun 2026); named one of Sweden's best-managed companies (May 2026). [ESBE news]

Fernox · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Element Solutions (NYSE: ESI) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Launched an enhanced commercial water-treatment range, shown at InstallerSHOW 2026 (Jun 2026). [InstallerSHOW]

Siemens Smart Infrastructure* · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Listed (Siemens AG), segment · revenue ~EUR 23bn run-rate (FY 2026 quarters) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Fiscal Q2 2026: revenue ~EUR 5.9bn, profit EUR 1.1bn (18.6%); record data-centre orders EUR 1.9bn; H1 data-centre revenue +45% to EUR 1.8bn. [TED Magazine]

Alfa Laval · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (Nasdaq Stockholm: ALFA) · revenue SEK 52.6bn (9M 2026) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Q2 2026: order intake SEK 22.2bn (+29% organic), net sales SEK 18.1bn, adj. EBITA margin 17.0% (17.8%). [Alfa Laval Q2 2026 report]

Resideo (Honeywell Home) · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (NYSE: REZI) · revenue USD 7.5bn (2025, incl. ADI) · FTEs ~14,600 (data aggregator)

- **Performance:** Q2 2026: revenue ~USD 1.98bn (+2%), Products & Solutions +4%; input-cost pressure (memory, metals, PCBs) expected to peak in Q3. [GuruFocus]

Victaulic · relevance 2/5 (low)

Private · revenue ~USD 5.1bn (2026, IBISWorld estimate) · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Marked 100 years since its first mechanical pipe-joining patent (4 Apr 2026); 309,000 sq ft distribution centre in Halfway, Maryland due to open in H1 2026. [ACR News · Modern Distribution Management]

No dated public information found for this period: Taco Comfort Solutions (4), ADEY (3), Armstrong Fluid Technology (3), Cetetherm (3), Frese (3), Giacomini (3), HERZ Armaturen (3), PAW (3), PEWO Energietechnik (3), Wessels Company (3), Wilo (3), Zilmet (3).

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).